

CONSUMER PRICE INDICES AND INFLATION RATES FOR MAY 2025

Annual consumer price inflation as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI) was 3.8 per cent in May 2025. This implies that the general price level was 3.8 per cent higher in May 2025 than it was in May 2024. The price increase was primarily driven by rise in prices of items in the Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages (6.3%); Transport (2.3%) and Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and other fuels (0.8%) over the one year period. These three divisions together account for over 57 per cent of the total weight across the 13 major expenditure categories.

The CPI measures the cost of purchasing a fixed basket of goods and services, comparing current prices to those of a base period (February 2019). The inflation rate is derived from data collected through a monthly survey of retail prices that targets a representative basket of household goods and services, with data gathered during the second and third weeks of the month from a statistically representative sample of outlets in urban areas across 50 data collection zones nationwide.

As presented in Table 1 and Table 2, the overall index increased from 144.09 in April 2025 to 144.88 in May 2025, resulting in a monthly inflation of 0.5 per cent.

Table 1: Overall CPI and Rates of Inflation

Index Reference Period Feb 2019 = 100		
Month	Overall CPI	Inflation Rate
May 2024	139.64	5.0
June 2024	140.23	4.6
July 2024	139.94	4.3
August 2024	139.87	4.4
September 2024	140.13	3.6
October 2024	140.44	2.7
November 2024	140.81	2.8
December 2024	141.66	3.0
January 2025	142.68	3.3
February 2025	143.12	3.5
March 2025	143.69	3.6
April 2025	144.09	4.1
May 2025	144.88	3.8

As shown in Table 2, the Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages Index increased by 1.2 per cent between April 2025 and May 2025. Notably, prices of potatoes (Irish), oranges and fresh packeted cow milk dropped by 3.7, 1.8 and 0.6 per cent, respectively, between April 2025 and May 2025. In the same period, prices of sugar, maize flour sifted and kale- *Sukuma wiki* rose by 4.3, 3.9 and 3.5 per cent, respectively, as presented in Table 3, which provides national average prices of selected items.

The Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels' Index had a negligible change between April 2025 and May 2025. During the same period, price of a 50 kWh unit of electricity and a 200 kWh unit of electricity declined by 1.0 per cent and 0.9 per cent. The price of gas/LPG dropped by 0.5 per cent over the same period.

As detailed in Table 2, the Transport Index rose by 0.2 per cent between April 2025 and May 2025 mainly attributable to increase in prices of international flights. Prices of petrol and diesel remained the same in the review period, as presented in Table 3.

Table 2: One and Twelve-Month Percentage Changes in the Consumer Price Indices

	Weight %	% Change on last month (May 2025/ April 2025)	% Change on same month of the previous year (May 2025/ May 2024)
13 COICOP Divisions			
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	32.9094	1.2	6.3
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	3.3289	0.1	5.5
Clothing and Footwear	2.9914	0.1	3.6
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	14.6124	0.0	0.8
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance	3.7372	0.2	3.0
Health	2.9116	0.2	3.6
Transport	9.6468	0.2	2.3
Information and Communication	7.7840	0.1	0.9
Recreation, Sport and Culture	1.7219	0.3	3.4
Education Services	5.5620	0.2	2.9
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	8.0991	0.1	3.8
Insurance and Financial Services	2.2423	0.0	0.9
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	4.4532	0.4	3.7
Total	100.0000	0.5	3.8

Table 3: National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

Commodity Name	Quantity	Unit of Measure	Average Price May 2024	Average Price May 2025	Average Price May 2025	% Change over last month May 2025/ April 2025	% Change over last year May 2025/ May 2024
Potatoes (Irish)	1	Kg	118.74	131.55	126.67	-3.7	6.7
Oranges	1	Kg	92.98	110.18	108.15	-1.8	16.3
Fresh packeted cow milk	500	Millilitre	57.42	56.72	56.40	-0.6	-1.8
Tomatoes	1	Kg	74.35	81.88	82.88	1.2	11.5
Beef - With Bones	1	Kg	628.50	674.80	685.67	1.6	9.1
Maize Grain - Loose	1	Kg	61.94	66.60	68.49	2.8	10.6
Kale-Sukuma Wiki	1	Kg	74.90	86.47	89.53	3.5	19.5
Maize Flour - Sifted	2	Kg	137.70	151.02	156.92	3.9	14.0
Sugar	1	Kg	172.72	167.25	174.47	4.3	1.0
Electricity	50	kWh	1,277.19	1,315.81	1,302.35	-1.0	2.0
Electricity	200	kWh	6,076.76	5,877.92	5,824.08	-0.9	-4.2
Gas/LPG	13	Kg	3,221.29	3,156.19	3,141.30	-0.5	-2.5
House rent - single room	1	Per Month	4,101.46	4,169.57	4,169.57	0.0	1.7
Kerosene/Paraffin	1	Litre	169.52	149.78	149.78	0.0	-11.6
Petrol	1	Litre	193.46	175.30	175.30	0.0	-9.4
Diesel	1	Litre	179.91	165.64	165.64	0.0	-7.9

Core inflation was 2.8 per cent in May 2025, as presented in Table 4. This was mainly due to increase in price of commodities in the core basket such as fortified maize flour, wheat flour among others. The core index increased from 128.48 in April 2025 to 128.97 in May 2025. Non-core inflation was 6.0 per cent during the same period.

Table 4: Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation Rate

Period	Core index	Core Inflation	Non-Core index	Non-Core Inflation
May-24	125.49	3.4	197.51	10.2
Jun-24	125.66	2.8	198.96	10.1
Jul-24	125.66	2.2	197.48	10.8
Aug-24	125.80	2.2	195.90	10.3
Sep-24	125.88	2.0	196.87	7.7
Oct-24	126.20	1.8	197.36	5.1
Nov-24	126.76	2.1	197.51	4.6
Dec-24	127.50	2.2	198.51	4.9
Jan-25	127.77	2.0	202.87	6.8
Feb-25	128.01	1.9	204.01	7.7
Mar-25	128.35	2.2	205.55	7.4
Apr-25	128.48	2.5	206.86	8.4
May-25	128.97	2.8	209.35	6.0

Contribution of core and non-core inflation to the overall inflation is presented in Table 5. Core inflation contributed 2.7 points while non-core contributed 1.1 points to the overall inflation in May 2025. Food and non-alcoholic beverages contributed to 1.9 points to the overall inflation.

Table 5: Core and Non-Core Contributions, May 2025

Broad Categories	Core	Non Core	Total
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	0.8	1.2	1.9
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	0.2	0.0	0.2
Clothing and Footwear	0.2	0.0	0.2
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	0.1	-0.1	0.0
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household	0.2	0.0	0.2
Health	0.1	0.0	0.1
Transport	0.2	0.0	0.2
Information and Communication	0.1	0.0	0.1
Recreation, Sport and Culture	0.1	0.0	0.1
Education Services	0.2	0.0	0.2
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	0.3	0.0	0.3
Insurance and Financial Services	0.0	0.0	0.0
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods	0.2	0.0	0.2
Total	2.7	1.1	3.8



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